Stay Awake

A Fragmented Collector board game · 4–8 players · 30–45 min · ages 14+ · contains dark themes

The Captives win

- if a vote exposes the Collector,
- if a Captive reaches the front door and names the Collector, or
- if the Collector's awareness drops to 0.

The Collector wins

- by reaching the front door, or
- when only one Captive is left in the game.

★ In the game

- 1 board (A3, or two A4 sheets taped together)
- 54 Fall cards
- 8 role cards: 1 Collector and 7 Captives
- 8 figures and 8 candle cards
- 2 Sedation tokens

You also need **1 die**, **8 paper clips** and a phone as a **1-minute timer**.

1 Setup

1. Put the board in the middle and all the figures on **Start**.
2. Everyone picks a colour: a figure and a candle card. Put a paper clip on candle **3**.
3. Take the **Collector** card and enough **Captive** cards for one each. Shuffle them and deal them face down. Look at yours in secret and slide it under your candle card.
4. Shuffle the Fall cards. Everyone draws 1.
5. Put the 2 **Sedation tokens** on their place on the board.
6. The youngest player starts. Play goes to the left.

2 Your turn

1. **Roll and move** forward.
2. Landed at the start of a **vent**? Crawl to where the duct ends. Landed on **Dozed off**? Slide back to where the pink line ends.
3. **Do what the space says:** Card, Night or Talk. A blank floor space does nothing.

Several figures may stand on the same space.

3 Fall cards

- Read your card **in silence**.
- **Captives** may only use the white half. The **Collector** may use either half, and the white one is great cover.
- If it says **Keep**, keep it in your hand (at most 3). Otherwise, do it at once.
- **Say what you do, never what the card says.** Then discard it face down.
- Every card is listed in the rules, so anyone may check what a card *could* have said.

4 Night

1. The player who landed says: **"Night falls."**
2. Everyone closes their eyes and taps the table: **three taps**, a short pause, ten times over. Count your own taps.
3. While tapping, the **Collector** opens their eyes and quietly puts a Sedation token on someone's candle card. It can be their own card, to look innocent, or no card at all. Then the Collector's eyes close again, and the tapping goes on.
4. After ten rounds of taps, everyone opens their eyes.
5. A token on your candle card: **lose 1 awareness**, unless you discard a *Stay awake* card. The tokens go back.

Peeking ruins the game. Keep your eyes shut.

5 Talk and vote

1. Start a 1-minute timer. Everyone may talk, accuse, lie and defend.
2. When it rings, the player who started the talk may **accuse** one player, or pass.
3. On "three", everyone except the accused shows **thumbs up or down**.
4. More thumbs up than down: the accused shows their role card.
   - **The Collector?** The Captives win.
   - **A Captive?** That Captive is out, and the accuser loses 1 awareness.

6 Awareness and being out

Everyone starts at 3: **Stay aware, Stay away, Stay awake.** At **0** you are **collected**: show your role card and move your figure to **The Collection** on the board.

Players who are out stay at the table, but they don't talk, vote or tap.

The Collector can lose awareness too. If the Collector reaches 0, the Captives win.

7 The front door

You don't need the exact number to get out.

- **A Captive gets out:** they get **the last word** and name one player, with no vote. If it's the Collector, the Captives win. If not, that Captive escaped alone and is out of the game.
- **The Collector gets out:** they show their card, and the Collector wins.

8 Why it's hard to tell

- Most of the time, the Collector uses the same white texts as everyone else.
- A token can land on the Collector's own candle.
- Cards like *Steel on every window* and *A sweet voice* let Captives hold each other back too.
- Kept cards look the same, whichever half they're for.
- A wrong vote costs the Captives a player, so the Collector wins by sowing doubt.

♥ About the tone

The book is about control, sedation and people being taken. The game keeps that at a distance: no one is hurt on the table, and "collected" just means you're out of the game. It's about bluffing, talking and staying awake together. Put a short content warning on the rules.

Every Fall card

Card	Captive	Collector only
Stay awake ×3	**Keep.** When you are sedated, discard it and lose nothing.	**Keep.** At Night, discard it to place a second token.
Three taps ×2	Move forward 3.	Pick a player. They move back 3.
Steel on every window ×2	Pick a player, you too if you like. They skip their next turn.	Pick a player. They skip their next two turns.
You owe me ×2	Swap one card with another player. You each choose what to give.	Swap one card with another player. You take theirs without looking.
A sweet voice ×2	Pick a player. You both move back 2.	Everyone else moves back 1.
Too much light ×2	Look at one card in another player's hand.	Look at two cards in another player's hand.
Read between the lines ×2	Look at the top 3 Fall cards and put them back in any order.	The same, but you may put any of them at the bottom.
Happy birthday to me ×2	Everyone else moves back 1.	Move forward 3.
Ghosts on the porch ×2	Swap places with any player behind you.	Swap places with any player.
The family table ×2	Start a Talk now.	First look at one card in someone's hand. Then start a Talk.
Air pods in ×2	**Keep.** If a vote goes against you, discard it: the vote fails.	**Keep.** If a vote goes against you, discard it: the vote fails.
PING! ×1	Move forward to the next Night space. Night falls.	Night falls right now, wherever you are.
Walls that swallow ×2	Lose 1 awareness. Then draw 2 cards.	Pick a player. They lose 1 awareness. Draw 1 card.
Fall in or fall out ×2	Move forward 4 and lose 1 awareness, or stay where you are.	Move forward 4, or stay where you are.
Stop requested ×2	Move forward to the next Talk space and start a Talk.	Move to any Talk space, ahead or behind, and start a Talk.
Roxies or Oxies ×2	Draw 2 cards. Keep 1 and discard the other face down.	Draw 2 cards and keep both.
Strapped for cash ×2	Discard a card from your hand, then move forward 2.	Move forward 2.
Hood up ×2	Move forward 2.	Move forward 2, or back 2 to stay close to someone.
The 611 ×2	Move to the next Card space ahead and draw a card.	Move to the nearest Card space, ahead or behind, and draw a card.
Not now… ×2	**Keep.** Discard it to cancel a card another player is playing.	**Keep.** Discard it to cancel a card another player is playing.
A trick of the mind ×2	Pick two other players. They swap places on the board.	Pick two other players. They swap places on the board.
Smile for the camera ×2	Everyone shows how many cards they hold.	Everyone except you shows how many cards they hold.
Eyes wide open ×2	Name another player. At the next Night, if they get a token, you lose the awareness instead.	Name another player. At the next Night, if they get a token, you lose the awareness instead.
Be like water ×2	Gain 1 awareness (at most 3).	Gain 1 awareness (at most 3).
Be your own light ×2	If you have 1 awareness, gain 2. If not, move forward 2.	Move forward 2.
Candles low ×2	Night falls now.	Night falls now. Tonight you may place both tokens.
Trenton makes ×2	Everyone gives one card to the player on their left.	Everyone gives one card to the player on their left. You may give none.